



Veronica, in Mumbai, sees a high GenZ footfall. Alcohol-light, daytime-friendly concepts attract younger diners

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tor of Sales and Marketing at the properties.

Shorter, more frequent breaks have replaced long annual holidays. Weekend staycations, brunch-led getaways and event-driven travel dominate, alongside hybrid work trips. At Moxy Bengaluru Airport Prestige Tech Cloud, a brand designed explicitly around younger travellers, this shift is structural rather than reactive. “We didn’t adapt to Gen Z later, we were built with them in mind,” says Anuradha Venkatachalam, the hotel’s manager.

For Gen Z, design and comfort must coexist. “Instagrammability matters, but not in isolation,” Venkatachalam adds. “Form and

function are inseparable.”

In Goa, Gen Z’s disregard for conventional travel rhythms is even more pronounced. “There is no fixed season or weekday-weekend pattern,” says Pratiti Rajpal, General Manager of Ronil Goa—a JdV by Hyatt Hotel. The appeal lies in freedom and vibe: check-ins at the bar, midnight swims, pet-friendly stays and a non-judgmental, social atmosphere.

Sustainability and local immersion further differentiate this cohort. At Palm Grove Beach Resort in Goa, Eva Agardsdotter, Partner, observes that eco-conscious practices strongly influence Gen Z choices. “They often prefer accommodations that demonstrate real

responsibility towards the environment and local communities,” she says, pointing to the resort’s mud-built Little Palm Grove extension and community-led beach clean-ups. Guests gravitate towards yoga, village walks, night markets and workshops rather than traditional luxury cues.

Redefinition of Luxury

For large hotel groups, these shifts have strategic implications. At Marriott International, Gen Z has emerged as one of the fastest-growing segments in India—a trend visible through rising engagement with the Marriott Bonvoy loyalty programme.

“Our research shows that younger travellers are entering the travel ecosystem much earlier and travelling more frequently,” says Khushnooma Kapadia, Vice President of Marketing for South Asia at Marriott International. “What’s important is that Gen Z is not a future audience anymore. They’re already shaping demand, brand expectations, and engagement strategies.”

Social media, she adds, now plays a decisive role.

Across segments, Gen Z consistently prioritises neighbourhood immersion over spectacle. “Luxury for them is access,” says Kapadia. “Access to culture, people, and experiences that feel real.”

Experiential operators see similar patterns. At destinations such as Gujarat’s Rann Utsav and Dholavira, Gen Z travellers gravitate towards participative experiences. “They’re far more interested in local immersion than traditional grandeur,” says Krinal Thaker, Marketing Head at Evoke Experiences, a destination-driven hospitality company. “Luxury is now measured by uniqueness and relevance, not opulence.”

Heritage walks, archaeological storytelling, folk music and stargazing rank high among Gen Z prefer-